

Bronte Harbour Classic 5K — Monthly Team Meeting

Meeting Minutes — March 4, 2026

Date: Wednesday, March 4, 2026

Time: ~1:30 PM (in-person)

Location: [In-person — Oakville/Burlington area]

Duration: Approximately 1 hour 34 minutes

Attendees:

- Greg Kowalczyk — Co-Race Director (TapeGeeks / GearTOP)
- Jono Spies
- Myles Cameron
- Patricia (TapeGeeks)
- Adriana
- Yasmine (hello@startwithyaz.com)

Apologies:

- Charles J. Sathmary — Co-Race Director (unavailable)
- Ursula (noted as absent during shirt/apparel discussion)

Race Status: 109 days to race day (June 21, 2026)

Current Registrations: ~91 participants | Target: 800

1. Registration & Fundraising

- Registration currently sitting at approximately 91 participants against a target of 800.
- The team acknowledged that April and May will require a significant marketing push to drive registrations.
- Pricing remains in the February 1 – March 31 tier; urgency increases after March 31 when pricing steps up.
- No specific fundraising updates were discussed beyond the Oakville Dads charity alignment.

2. Sponsorships & Partnerships

Confirmed Sponsors

- **CIBC** — Confirmed founding sponsor (\$5,000). Payment not yet received. Booth confirmed.
- **ON Running** — Confirmed as Official Shoe Sponsor. Currently at 8 pairs of shoes; team pushing for 10–12 pairs as race prizes.
- **Radix / Natrilyte** — Confirmed as Official Hydration/Water Station Sponsor. Will provide electrolyte product at finish line. Booth to be set up at the expo. Note: Radix and Natrilyte are presented as the same sponsorship.

- **Be Active (Physio)** — Confirmed sponsor; will sponsor all race prizes and have a booth at the expo.

Pending / In Negotiation

Cedar Planters (Title Sponsor — Priority)

- Cedar Planters relocated from Spears Avenue to the Great Lakes area (new warehouse on Greyhouse).
- Greg had an existing relationship with them and messaged their WhatsApp. It then emerged that **Liz (Liz Carino) is both a volunteer committee member for BHC and works at Cedar Planters** — this was a surprise to the group.
- Patricia reached out to Liz approximately 2 days before the meeting; Liz responded that she was too busy and has not yet engaged further.
- Cedar Planters was brought to attention as a potential title sponsor by Kayla from the Bronte BIA.
- **Situation to navigate:** Liz's dual role as committee member and Cedar Planters employee creates a potential conflict of interest. The team needs to determine how to approach this sensitively — whether Liz is the right point of contact or whether a separate direct approach is needed.
- Status: **Pending — follow-up required immediately.**

Rockstar Real Estate Brokerage

- Greg has a long-standing personal relationship with the owners.
- Approached as title sponsor but they declined due to current economic conditions ("times are tough").
- However, they agreed to support the event through advertising and promotion.
- They will provide **a table/booth at their April 25 real estate conference** at the Airport Road Convention Centre — approximately 1,000 attendees, all local investors, running from 8 AM to 2 PM with networking breaks.
- They have a **podcast**: Greg and Charles are booked to record an episode about the race (how it was conceived, marketing, community element). Recording date TBD.
- Will advertise in their newsletter.
- Status: **Confirmed as promotional partner; booth/presence at April 25 event confirmed.**

Tim Hortons

- Discussed as a vendor/coffee truck presence (not supplying free coffee to all participants — operating as a vendor).
- No confirmation yet. Follow-up required.

Nickelbrook Brewery

- Being pursued for beer garden sponsorship/operation.
- Status: **Not confirmed. Follow-up required.**

Lululemon (Burlington location)

- The owner of the Burlington Lululemon location was identified as a potential announcer for the event, and was previously an announcer for Oakville events.
- By the time her contact was obtained, a Toronto-based announcer had already been committed.
- Lululemon Burlington still being considered as a sponsor or booth participant.
- **Lululemon Toronto contact** was also mentioned in the context of running influencer outreach (approached via Instagram DM).

Red Bull

- Red Bull expressed interest in bringing their branded truck with DJ setup to the event.
- They indicated they can "come with anything" and are interested.
- The team noted they have their own music programming (bands), but Red Bull as a brand presence would add energy.
- Status: **Pending sponsor commitment.** Documented internally as "Red Bull — pending sponsor."

Primal (Fitness Studio)

- Discussed as a potential vendor booth participant and sponsor.
- The group discussed exclusivity: exclusivity in a category can only be offered if a partner commits for 3 years in a row.
- Action: Reach out to Primal to offer vendor booth + swag bag contribution opportunity.

Peach Coffee / Colombia Coffee

- Discussed as potential in-store poster placement partners and possible small sponsors (\$250 level).
- Approach: ask them to put a poster in store and offer a 25% discount promotion to their customers; if they decline, approach Colombia Coffee (neighbouring location).

3. Vendor Expo & Logistics

Layout & Booth Count

- Current vendor map has approximately 68–70 vendor spaces (reduced from an earlier version with 160 booths — the 160 count was impractical; 60–70 is the working plan).
- Vendor booth pricing confirmed:
- **\$250** — Booth space at the expo
- **\$250 + \$100 additional** = \$350 total for booth + swag bag item contribution
- **\$230** — Swag bag contribution only (no booth)
- Corner booth premium pricing: to be determined.
- Booth locations for confirmed partners: Be Active, CIBC, Radix/Natrilyte, Oakville Dads, BIA, Town of Oakville, Saint John Ambulance — all to be confirmed and assigned numbers on the map.
- Vendor map to be finalized, then submitted to the Town of Oakville for approval.
- Once finalized, booths will be numbered and vendor assignments fixed.

Vendor Application

- The vendor application was reviewed briefly at the meeting — it was considered largely complete.
- Action: Complete any outstanding sections and get it live.
- Action: Build a working spreadsheet of committed vendors.

Porta-Potties

- **Yasmine has obtained a quote.** Quantity discussed: 7–8 units.
- Industry ratio: approximately 1 unit per 75–100 attendees. The park also has existing washroom facilities.
- Placement: top-left area of the site map, away from the start line and close to the parking area.
- Action: Finalize booking now — Yasmine to confirm.

Food Trucks

- Food trucks are positioned along the main path in the current layout and are considered well-placed.
- The area near the food trucks needs to be kept clear for truck arrival/setup (vehicles driving in).
- Note: Food trucks are different from vendor booths; both are being managed.

Equipment & Supplies

- Burlington Sound of Music organizers (Greg was in contact) have offered to **lend tents, barriers, and tables**. Terms (exchange for what) still to be worked out.
- Action: Reach out to Sound of Music organizers to confirm what equipment is available and on what basis.

Bronte Legion

- The Bronte Legion has a parking lot that may be available for vendor parking or exhibiting.
- Action: Confirm parking lot access with the Legion.

Vendor Arrival & Staggering

- Setup crew on-site from 4–5 AM.
- Roads close at 7 AM.
- Vendor arrival times to be staggered to prevent congestion at the entrance.
- Expo runs 8 AM to 3 PM.

Swim Club / Summer Camps

- Discussed as potential vendor/booth participants.
- Action: Check with local swim club; reach out to summer camps and youth programs.

Vendor with Breathing / Yoga

- "Manjit" (name from transcript) — associated with a breathing/yoga studio — was identified as a potential vendor.
- "Nancy" (from Ace) was suggested as someone who could help promote vendor opportunities.

4. Route & Traffic Control

Two Route Options Under Review

- A traffic control plan and map were submitted to the Town of Oakville. The submission came after Greg had reached a point of needing a backup contact, and the traffic control company felt pressure and submitted.

- **Route Option 1 (preferred):** The original route discussed — described as the more appealing option. The route goes along the waterfront and loops back. Specific details reference going "around the parking lot and back," avoiding John Street, and providing a smoother traffic management scenario.
- **Route Option 2 (alternative):** A different routing that the group considered but found less appealing for traffic flow.
- Final route direction (clockwise vs. counterclockwise) pending Town of Oakville approval.
- Both routes are under review with the Town. Changes from the town are expected.

Apartment Building Exits

- Along the race route, **every single apartment building exit must be staffed** with a volunteer in a high-visibility vest to prevent residents from driving out during the race.
- The team needs to count the exact number of apartment exits along the route to determine volunteer requirements.
- Traffic control barricades are specified in the plan for each apartment exit.

Start/Finish Line

- Start line location referenced on the map. Timing equipment placement to be confirmed once route is approved.
- Chip timing confirmed for the 5K race.

5. Marketing & Media

BIA Newsletter

- Greg met with **Kayla from the Bronte BIA** — a productive meeting. Kayla is fully supportive of the race and committed to spreading the word.
- Greg already submitted a piece for the BIA newsletter; it **will be published in the newsletter going out at the beginning of March** (already submitted as of meeting date).
- Kayla provided media contacts including: **Oakville News, Inside Halton, TV Halton.**
- The BIA has a vendor network of approximately 70 vendors for their marketplace — they will reach out to their vendor list on behalf of BHC.
- Kayla also has contacts at the **Kerr Street business association** — to be leveraged for additional media outreach.

Media Contacts

- Additional media contact: A photographer for the **Burlington News** was met in person during a Sunday run and given the race contact details.
- Full media list assembled: TV Halton, Inside Halton, Oakville News, Burlington News.
- Action: Prepare a formal media release with a photograph and distribute to all media contacts.

Poster Campaign

- A poster with QR code needs to be printed (updated version with QR code required — current version may not have it).
- Plan: Print 50+ posters; divide among 5 team members (10 posters each) to distribute this coming **Saturday and Sunday** at:
 - Local coffee shops (Peach Coffee, Colombia Coffee)
 - Local businesses
 - BIA gazebo area (one poster already discussed for the BIA-owned gazebo)
 - The distribution effort can be documented on social media.
- Action: Finalize poster design with QR code; print 50+ copies; coordinate distribution weekend.

Social Media Giveaway

- Discussed as a mechanism to grow followers and engagement quickly.
- Idea: A "follow us and tag" style giveaway.
- Leverage existing sponsors' and committed partners' social media channels to amplify.
- Action: Design and launch a giveaway campaign.

Running Influencers & Community Outreach

- Strategy: Find running coaches and influencers via Instagram, follow and DM them.
- Specific contacts to pursue:
 - **Runner's Den** — Greg is about to reach out.
 - **Lululemon Toronto** — already connected via Instagram DM approach.
 - **Lucas at Running Room** — Charles's contact; noted as someone who can connect to other running communities. To be followed up.
- Action: Systematically reach out to running influencers and coaches.

Rockstar Real Estate — April 25 Conference

- At the April 25 Airport Road Convention Centre conference (~1,000 local attendees), BHC will have a **table/booth presence**.
- Greg to coordinate logistics for this.
- Podcast episode with Charles and Greg to be recorded (timing TBD).

"Your Life Your Terms" Podcast

- Greg and Charles are booked for an episode on the Rockstar Real Estate podcast ("Your Life Your Terms").
- Content will cover the race concept, marketing, and community story.
- Content can be repurposed across BHC's own channels.

6. Design & Merchandise

Medals

- Meeting with **Kelly, Greg Pace, and Charles** is planned (this Sunday) to discuss the **three-race series medal design**:
- Moon in June (Burlington)
- Bronte Harbour Classic (Oakville)
- Canada Day (location TBD)
- Concept: **Interlocking medals** — each individual race medal can be combined/interlocked with the others to form one larger piece when a participant completes all three races.
- Participants completing all three races would receive a **fourth special medal** (bonus for the series).
- Price reduction for series participants also discussed.
- Medal type: design will differ depending on whether interlocking (cast) vs. stamped metal — this affects the design brief.
- Note: It's unclear whether Moon in June or Canada Day race have already ordered/designed their medals. This needs to be confirmed before BHC commits to a shared design direction.
- A local designer may be engaged for the medal design.

T-Shirts

- Shirt supplier: **Brent from Global Citizen** — Greg met with Brent on the day of the meeting.
- T-shirt timeline: 6–8 weeks before race day (so approximately mid-April at the latest for design finalization).
- Design concept: Light-colored shirt (light blue discussed); sponsor logos on the back; race branding on front.
- Printing spec: **Single-color print** or **color shirt + up to 3 colors** (per Brent's recommendation). If using a colored shirt, a base layer may be needed under additional colors.
- Style debate: Some team members noted that technical running shirts (dry-fit) are often not worn after the race. Preference expressed for a more **casual/lifestyle shirt** (e.g., cotton/poly blend) that people will actually wear post-race.
- Action: Finalize design direction; confirm specs with Brent; place order approximately 6–8 weeks out from race day.
- Volunteer shirts: Separate design for volunteers, potentially with a distinct logo treatment. High-vis vests for on-course volunteers (see Section 8).

7. Event Layout & Setup

A site map was reviewed during the meeting. Key layout decisions discussed:

- **Kids Zone:** Moved to the bottom-right corner, near the **water feature** in the park, so children can access the water and the kids zone together. Note: the kids zone and water feature may need to be cordoned off from each other for safety.
- **Beer Garden:** Originally near the kids zone; now being repositioned. Two proposals discussed:
 - Place beer garden near the music stage (bottom-left corner) — keeps the "adults area" together.
 - Place beer garden in the first few rows of vendor space near the stage — this risks bisecting foot traffic flow and may disadvantage vendors on the other side.
 - Group preference leaned toward beer garden adjacent to the music stage in a dedicated corner area, similar to how other festivals manage it.
- **Music Stage:** Bottom-left corner of the site. Power confirmed available at the stage location.
- **Food Trucks:** Current placement considered good — positioned along the main path. The food truck entry/exit lane must be kept clear.
- **Porta-Potties:** Top-left area, near the parking, away from the start line.
- **Jumping Castle / Inflatable:** Need to identify a flat area for setup.
- **Booth Numbering:** Once layout is finalized, all booths to be numbered and vendor assignments locked in.
- **Seating:** Grass seating area near the performance stage to be identified.

8. Volunteers & Operations

Oakville Dads

- **Oakville Dads confirmed** as the primary volunteer organization — expected to supply **60+ volunteers**.
- Greg had a recent meeting with Oakville Dads.
- Monthly coordination meetings between BHC team and Oakville Dads recommended going forward.
- Oakville Dads booth confirmed at the expo.

Shift Times

- **4–5 AM:** Setup crew and team on-site
- **7 AM:** Roads close; barricades go up
- **8 AM:** Race / expo opens
- **3 PM:** Expo closes

High-Visibility Vests

- All on-course volunteers (particularly at apartment building exits) need **high-vis vests**.
- Options: Purchase branded vests, or borrow from other races (Greg Pace / Moon in June inventory was mentioned as a possible source).

- Traffic control company likely supplies their own vests/barricades for their staff; BHC still needs vests for the race's own volunteers.
- Action: Determine whether vests need to be procured or can be borrowed; count required quantity based on apartment exit count.

Volunteer Shirts

- Volunteers will have their own designated shirts/vest with branding (distinct from race participant shirts).

9. Music & Entertainment

Live Bands

- Plan: **2–3 local bands**, each playing 2-hour sets, from 10 AM to 3 PM.
- One band suggested may be more of a "nighttime" style — suitability for a daytime family festival to be considered.
- Jono noted he has contacts for bands.
- Burlington Sound of Music organizers also mentioned as a source for musician contacts.
- Action: Jono to finalize band lineup.

Red Bull Truck

- Red Bull has expressed interest in bringing their branded truck with a DJ setup.
- If Red Bull comes, they would handle their own music/DJ element, which the team would need to coordinate with the band schedule (so they don't compete).
- Red Bull's participation is contingent on confirming them as a sponsor.
- Action: Finalize Red Bull sponsor commitment before confirming truck.

Announcer

- A Toronto-based announcer has already been committed: available 6:30 AM – 3 PM (approximately 8 hours).
- The Lululemon Burlington owner was identified as someone with announcing experience but was connected too late to be engaged for this role.
- Action: Confirm announcer details and contract.

10. Permits & Operations

Race Insurance

- **\$5M CGL (Commercial General Liability) race insurance** — application not yet completed.
- This is a critical outstanding item. The insurance application needs to be filled out and submitted.
- Action: Complete and submit race insurance application. **Priority.**

Town of Oakville

- Traffic control plan submitted to the Town. Changes and feedback from the Town are expected.
- Once the revised plan (incorporating Town feedback) is finalized, it will be resubmitted for approval.
- The vendor site map also needs to be submitted to the Town for approval.
- Action: Monitor Town of Oakville review; address any requested changes promptly.

Resident Notifications

- Residents in apartments and townhouses along the race route need to be notified of road closures.
- Method: Deliver notices **by hand** to building managers and townhouses.
- Action: Prepare resident notification letters; coordinate hand delivery.

11. Meeting Cadence

- **Two weeks from now:** Zoom call — quick progress update (shorter and more focused than in-person meetings).
- **Monthly:** Continue in-person team meetings.
- The team confirmed this hybrid cadence (monthly in-person + bi-weekly Zoom) going forward.

Action Items

#	Action	Owner	Deadline
1	Complete and submit race insurance (\$5M CGL) application	Greg	ASAP — Priority
2	Follow up with Cedar Planters re: title sponsorship (navigate Liz's dual role carefully)	Greg / Patricia	This week
3	Finalize Radix/Natrilyte hydration station sponsorship details and booth assignment	Greg	ASAP
4	Follow up with Rockstar Real Estate re: April 25 conference table logistics	Greg	ASAP
5	Coordinate with Rockstar Real Estate to book podcast episode recording (Charles + Greg)	Greg	This week
6	Book Tim Hortons (vendor/coffee truck)	Greg	ASAP
7	Reach out to Nickelbrook re: beer garden	Greg	ASAP
8	Reach out to Primal re: vendor booth + swag bag contribution	Team	This week
9	Finalize Red Bull sponsor commitment; then confirm truck	Greg	ASAP

#	Action	Owner	Deadline
10	Confirm Lululemon Burlington as sponsor/booth (even if not announcer)	Greg	ASAP
11	Finalize and publish vendor application (complete any outstanding sections)	Patricia	ASAP
12	Build working spreadsheet of committed vendors	Jono	This week
13	Reduce vendor layout to 60–70 spaces; number all booths on site map	Jono	This week
14	Confirm porta-potty booking — 7–8 units; confirm pricing	Yasmine	ASAP
15	Contact Burlington Sound of Music organizers re: equipment lending (tents, barriers, tables)	Greg	This week
16	Confirm parking lot access with Bronte Legion for vendor parking	Greg	This week
17	Finalize site map and submit to Town of Oakville for approval	Greg	ASAP
18	Address Town of Oakville feedback on traffic control plan	Greg	Pending town
19	Count apartment exits along race route; determine volunteer quantity needed for high-vis coverage	Team	This week
20	Prepare resident notification letters re: road closures; organize hand delivery to building managers	Greg	2 weeks out from roads-close date
21	Determine if high-vis vests need to be purchased or can be borrowed (Moon in June, etc.)	Greg Pace / Greg	ASAP
22	Update poster design with QR code; print 50+ copies	Greg / Patricia	By this Friday
23	Coordinate poster distribution — 5 people, 10 posters each — this Saturday and Sunday	All team	This weekend
24	Submit media release with photo to: TV Halton, Inside Halton, Oakville News, Burlington News	Greg / team	ASAP
25	Approach Peach Coffee and Colombia Coffee re: poster placement + possible \$250 vendor/sponsor	Greg	This week
26	Reach out to Runner's Den re: influencer partnership / promotion	Greg	This week
27	Follow up with Lucas at Running Room (Charles's contact) for running community connections	Charles	This week
28	Design and launch social media giveaway (follow + tag mechanic)	Greg / Patricia	This week
29	Leverage existing sponsors' social media for cross-promotion	Patricia	Ongoing
30	Meeting with Kelly, Greg Pace, Charles to discuss interlocking three-race medal design	Greg + Greg Pace + Charles	This Sunday
31	Confirm Moon in June and Canada Day medal status before committing to interlocking design	Greg Pace	Before Sunday meeting
32	Finalize t-shirt design direction; confirm cotton/poly blend and single-color (or 3-color) spec with Brent	Greg	6–8 weeks before race (by ~mid-April)
33	Finalize beer garden and kids zone layout; resolve stage proximity question	Jono + Greg	Before Town submission
34	Identify flat area for jumping castle	Jono	Before Town submission
35	Confirm volunteer shirt/vest design and quantities	Greg / Patricia	6 weeks before race
36	Confirm Oakville Dads monthly coordination meeting schedule	Greg	This week
37	Finalize band lineup for expo (2–3 bands, 10 AM–3 PM)	Jono	4 weeks
38	Confirm announcer contract and schedule (6:30 AM – 3 PM)	Greg	ASAP

#	Action	Owner	Deadline
39	Reach out to swim club re: vendor booth interest	Team	This week
40	Explore summer camps and youth programs as potential vendor participants	Team	4 weeks
41	Schedule Zoom call in two weeks for progress update	Greg	By March 6

Minutes compiled from Lindy audio transcript, Apple iPhone audio transcript, and Lindy auto-generated action plan email (all dated March 4, 2026). Both audio transcripts attributed all speech to "Greg Kowalczyk" due to single-speaker AI detection; all attendees participated in the discussions captured above.